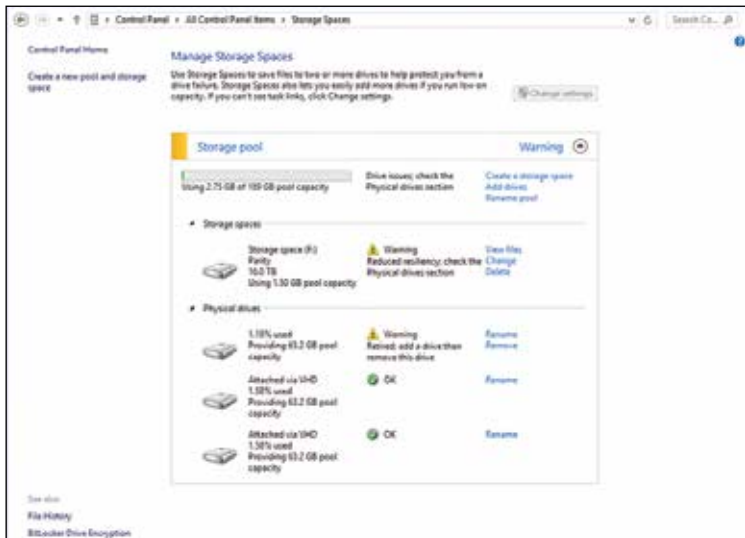


When you start to think of virtualisation in this way, you will begin to see it everywhere. For instance Libraries are virtual folders in recent versions of Windows that collect files from multiple folder while appearing to be a single folder.

Let's look at one final example, Storage Spaces in Windows 8 and above. This new feature virtualises storage in a way that improves the reliability and safety of your data. Storage spaces allows you to combine multiple hard drives into one storage “pool” that appears as a single hard drive. This “pool” can then be further divided into storage spaces that appear like the tradition C: drive and D: drive on your computer.

The benefit that Windows Storage Spaces provides is that it automatically keeps multiple copies of your data (if you so desire) across multiple drives, so if one fails, your data is not lost, and you system keeps running!



Windows storage spaces can also work with virtualised hard drives if you just want to check the feature out.

Also, it gives you the flexibility of planning ahead by creating larger storage spaces than you have hard disk space. So you can combine three 1TB drives and out of them create a storage space of 10TB. Rather than complain immediately Windows will allow this initially, and only complain if the hard drives themselves start running out of data. In that case simply add